



Sharma relishes Korean and Italian cuisines

ing way of knowing whether his son was religiously following the activity or not.

“My father would hand me the newspaper in the morning and ask me to underline all the grammatical mistakes that the stories covered. In the evening he would come back and ask me about the mistakes. This also made me ask him about the things I did not understand from the stories. Even today, if I pick up a newspaper, the first thing that pops right in front of me are the grammatical mistakes published in the stories,” Sharma says smiling as if his father is sitting right beside him.

“My mother taught me compassion, unconditional love and the power of faith,” added Sharma.

Deepika Sharma, the better half of Vinod Sharma, mentions, “The dedication of Vinod towards everything and anything that he does is commendable. Whether he is playing a football game in the park, taking dogs for a walk, or handling company matters, he is only dedicated to the task in hand.”

Football happens to be Sharma’s favourite sport. The reason he likes playing and watching this sport over any other concerns the rhythm and teamwork the game demands. “Whether you are the goalkeeper or striker, you are always equally involved in the game all the time,” he notes.

On not liking the fiction part, Sharma has now grown a taste in the same. But the only fiction books he is interested in are the ones that have been narrated or written in nothing less than an excellent manner. And what’s this excellent manner?

“Let me give you an example of

the same. I recently picked up a book by Arundhati Roy. The book was titled ‘God of Small Things,’ The reason I loved that book is because it is written impeccably well. The narration of the story is simply mind blowing,” explains Sharma.

He adds, “For getting my dose of fiction, I depend a lot on movies. And when it

comes to movies, Naseerudin Shah’s work excites me the most.”

Why I wrote a book

Sharma is a firm believer of life happening as per at least a loose plan. He believes that nothing in life is a coincidence. “There is at least a loose plan for you which God or nature makes for you,” he says.

Revisiting his days of association with a Dutch agency named Centre For Developing Imports From Developing Countries (CBI), he says professionals from this agency came to countries like India and trained industries here to become worthy of exporting their products to countries in Europe. The programme that this Dutch agency runs, as per Sharma, has the potential to open one’s eyes and let one know what the world wants.

This agency, under the programme, helps companies from India and other nations of the world to take part in exhibitions taking place in different parts of Europe, and Sharma was one of the exhibitors at one such big event in Europe. By the time the event ended Sharma was offered the role of a consultant trainer by the same agency. This role required Sharma to travel extensively and train individuals and industries located in other countries.

The association between the Dutch agency and Sharma continued for eight years. As a part of this association, Sharma had to travel outside India for one week every month and train people about the agency’s programme. Rest of the three weeks were dedicated to the expansion of Deki Electronics.

During the mid of these eight

years, Sharma was also made the president of ELCINA. Looking after the operations of Deki Electronics, being the president of ELCINA, and a training consultant with the Dutch agency became a bit hectic. It was quite clear that these three roles demanded undivided attention.

“It was then that I decided to close down the chapter of consulting. As I learned a lot from being trained by the agency, and also training there as a consultant, I decided that I was not going to quit without giving back. Hence came the idea of writing this book called ValueMagics,” he explains.

Along with his mentor and co-author, Hans Verhulft, Sharma has trained over two hundred consultants in the practice of Valuemagices. Sharma adds, “I continue to do sessions based on ValueMagics every two or three months. I think I owe a lot to what I learned from my experience with the Dutch agency, and this is my way of giving back and sharing my knowledge with the world.”

ELCINA and Buddhism connection

“Nobody has seen gravity, but we all know that if we throw something up in the air, the force of gravity will definitely pull it down. Same goes with the laws that govern society. Karma, or whatever name we give it, is as simple as that. The teachings of Buddhism make understanding these laws very simple, and that is why I was attracted to it,” says Sharma.

Sharma has been following Buddhism for years now and always remembers to take the name of Nichiren Daishonin whenever the subject comes up. Daishonin is one of the popular monks of Japan who tried to reform Buddhism and Japanese society during the 13th century. He is also referred to as a Buddhist Martin Luther. Remembering him during the conversation, Sharma points out a theory in Buddhism called ‘The Cause and Effect.’ As the name suggests, the theory points towards actions and their results.

“If I am writing in the dark, it does not mean that there’s nothing being written. It’s just that until light appears no one will be able to read it. This is simply cause and effect,” explains Sharma.